

MIND SHANTARA

মাইন্ড শান্তারা

“শান্ত হোক মন, স্বন্দর হোক জীবন”

Bangladesh's First Climate Anxiety & Mental Health Wellbeing Platform

COMPREHENSIVE STARTUP PLAN 2026

Business Model • Booking & Client Journey • Market Segmentation • Grant & Fellowship Strategy • Social Impact

Founder & Executive Director

humanitypubliclibrary.org | youthclimatenetworkbd.org | mindshantara.org

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Table of Contents

- 01. Executive Summary
- 02. Brand Identity — Mind Shantara
- 03. Market Validation — Global & Bangladesh Context
- 04. The Problem in Depth
- 05. The Mind Shantara Solution
- 06. Business Model — Hybrid Non-Profit + For-Profit Structure
- 07. Revenue Streams
- 08. Client Journey — How a Client Books & Receives Service
- 09. Market Segmentation Strategy
- 10. Website Architecture
- 11. Services in Detail
- 12. Marketing Strategy
- 13. Social Media Plan
- 14. Competitive Analysis
- 15. Financial Projections
- 16. National & International Grant + Fellowship Strategy
- 17. Team & Operations Plan
- 18. Social Impact Measurement
- 19. Founder's Vision
- 20. 12-Month Roadmap

Founder & Executive Director's Statement

On 25 May 2009, Cyclone Aila struck the coast of Bangladesh. Our home, our belongings, everything we had — washed away in hours. The embankment protecting our village along the Shipsha River broke, and the river simply walked in. What followed was not a single disaster but a slow, grinding one: for nearly three years, because the broken embankment could not be rebuilt, our community lived at the mercy of the tides — water rising and receding through our homes, our fields, and our lives, twice a day, every day.

I was nine years old. I lost my school before I ever fully understood what I was losing.

But Aila was not the only storm of my childhood. I grew up watching cyclone after cyclone tear through our coast — Sidr, Aila, Fani, Amphan — each one arriving with a different name but the same devastating signature: homes destroyed, harvests lost, children pulled out of school, families pushed deeper into hardship. Year after year, I watched the same communities rebuild, only to be struck down again. That repetition — of suffering, survival, and starting over — moved something in me that has never left. It was not abstract data or distant news. It was my neighbors. It was people I loved, losing everything, again and again, through no fault of their own.

Somewhere in the middle of all that loss, I made a decision I could not unmake: I would not simply survive this crisis. I would stand up and act — as a changemaker — to change the condition of the people around me who had suffered exactly as I had.

In 2021, that conviction led me to establish Humanity Public Library, so that children and families in climate-vulnerable coastal communities — like the one I grew up in — would never have to lose their education to a disaster the way I nearly did. It was never meant to be the end of the work. It was only the beginning.

That same conviction led to the founding of Youth Climate Network (YCN). Every program YCN runs today — from safe water access to disaster risk reduction to youth leadership training — carries the memory of a broken embankment, three years of uncertain tides, and a childhood measured out in cyclones. It is personal, and it is precisely why our work stays honest, urgent, and rooted in what frontline communities actually need — because I was one of them, and in many ways, I still am.

Mind Shantara is the next chapter of that same conviction. Where Humanity Public Library protects a child's right to learn and Youth Climate Network protects a community's right to a livable future, Mind Shantara protects something just as fragile and just as essential: the mind that has to carry all of it. Climate-displaced families, students under academic pressure, urban professionals, mothers, farmers on remote char islands — everyone deserves a safe space to heal, in their own language, without shame.

We are deeply grateful to the partners, donors, and institutions who have chosen to invest in that belief — trusting young people from Bangladesh's coast not just to survive the climate crisis, but to lead the fight against it.

There is an enormous distance still to travel. But I have seen what a cyclone can take from a community — and I have also seen what young people, given the trust and the tools, can rebuild in its place. This is only the beginning of that journey.

— **Arafat Hossain Akash**

Founder & Executive Director, Youth Climate Network

01. Executive Summary

Mind Shantara (মাইন্ড শান্তারা) is Bangladesh's first climate anxiety and mental health wellbeing platform, combining professional teleconsultation, peer support groups, self-help resources, and specialized climate-anxiety care. The

platform serves individuals through both free and paid services, integrated within the existing ecosystems of humanitypubliclibrary.org and youthclimatenetworkbd.org.

Brand tagline: “শান্ত হোক মন, স্বন্দর হোক জীবন” — “*Let the mind be calm, let life be beautiful.*”

Dimension	Details
Mission	Make mental health services accessible, affordable, and stigma-free for all Bangladeshis.
Vision	Become Bangladesh's leading mental health platform by 2030 and expand across South Asia.
Model	Hybrid Social Enterprise — Non-profit Foundation (grants, free tier) + For-profit Service Arm (paid sessions, B2B)
Channels	mindshantara.org · humanitypubliclibrary.org · youthclimatenetworkbd.org · Facebook · LinkedIn · Instagram
Year 1 Targets	BDT 37 Lakh revenue · 5,000 registered users · 500 paid consultations · 2 institutional grants

02. Brand Identity — Mind Shantara

The rename from “Moner Alo” to “Mind Shantara” strengthens global pronounceability while keeping the emotional, South Asian root (শান্তি / Shanti = peace). This dual-language name performs well with both Bangladeshi users and international grant/fellowship panels.

Naming Logic

Element	Rationale
Mind	Universally understood English word — signals a modern mental-wellness tech platform to global reviewers.
Shantara	Rooted in শান্তি (peace/calm) with a flowing, brandable ending — easy to pronounce worldwide.
Combined identity	Local authenticity + global accessibility, similar naming logic to Wysa, Calm, Headspace.

Taglines

- শান্ত হোক মন, সুন্দর হোক জীবন (Primary — Bengali, all local channels)
- Mind Shantara — Your Safe Space to Heal (English — international decks, grant proposals)
- যেখানে মন ঝুঁজে পায় নিরাপদ আশ্রয় (secondary — trust-building campaigns)

Visual Identity

Element	Direction
Logo concept	A calm, glowing star (Shantara) merging into a human silhouette / mind outline — with a subtle Bangladesh-green accent.
Colour palette	Teal / Sky Blue (trust, calm) + Amber-Saffron (warmth, hope) + Mint Green (renewal)
Typography	Rounded, warm sans-serif for Bengali + English bilingual headers
Brand voice	Warm, empathetic, science-based, inclusive, never clinical or cold

Domains & Handles — Registration Checklist

- mindshantara.org (Foundation / grant-facing) — register first, highest priority
- mindshantara.com (Business arm / app / paid services)
- Facebook: fb.com/MindShantara | Instagram: @mindshantara | LinkedIn: /company/mindshantara
- Verify via WIPO Global Brand Database + national trademark office (DPDT, Bangladesh) before public launch

03. Market Validation — Global & Bangladesh Context

Global Mental Health Landscape

Statistic	Value	Source
People living with mental health conditions globally	1.2 Billion+	The Lancet, May 2026
Increase in mental health burden since 1990	95.5%	WHO / The Lancet 2026
Rise in anxiety disorders among youth	158%	WHO 2026
Rise in depression among youth	131%	WHO 2026
Global digital mental health market (2026)	USD 9.8 Billion	Grand View Research
Projected market size by 2030	USD 24.1 Billion	MarketsandMarkets
Global economic cost of mental disorders by 2030	USD 16 Trillion	Frontiers in Psychiatry

Bangladesh Mental Health Crisis

Indicator	Value
Prevalence of mental health conditions	16.8% of population
Psychiatrists per 100,000 people	0.073 (critically low)
Share of health budget for mental health	0.44%
Psychiatrists working exclusively outside Dhaka	<35%
Total population served by ~500 psychiatrists	170 million people
Internet users in Bangladesh	130 Million+ (BTRC 2025)
Smartphone users	90 Million+ (Statista 2025)
Youth population aged 15–35	55 Million+ (BBS Census)

Key Insight: Bangladesh has a massive, underserved mental health gap — 170 million people supported by fewer than 500 psychiatrists. Climate anxiety from flooding, cyclones, and ecological stress is a fast-growing, Bangladesh-specific mental health driver — and Mind Shantara's unique wedge.

04. The Problem in Depth

Challenge	Description
Lack of Access	Almost no quality mental health services exist outside Dhaka. Online counseling is often the only viable option in rural or peri-urban areas.
Unaffordable Services	Private psychiatrist fees range BDT 1,500–3,000/session — far beyond the reach of average Bangladeshis.
Social Stigma	Mental illness is widely perceived as weakness or ‘madness’, preventing most from seeking help.
Climate Anxiety	Flooding, cyclones, and displacement are creating new, Bangladesh-specific psychological distress — eco-grief and climate anxiety.
Language Barrier	Most global resources are English-only; severe shortage of evidence-based Bangla content.
No Integrated Platform	Existing services are fragmented, expensive, or urban-centric — no single trusted bilingual platform covers all dimensions.

05. The Mind Shantara Solution

Founder's note: This is not a market gap identified from a distance. Our founder survived Cyclone Aila (2009) and nearly three years of tidal flooding that followed, and grew up watching Sidr, Fani, and Amphan repeat the same pattern of loss across his home community. Mind Shantara's climate-anxiety focus comes directly from that lived experience.

Mind Shantara creates an integrated ecosystem leveraging two existing organizations — humanitypubliclibrary.org and youthclimatenetworkbd.org — to deliver mental health support digitally to everyone.

Component	Description
Integrated Web Platform	mindshantara.org — dedicated mental health website with booking system, resources, community hub.
Slot Booking System	Free & paid appointment scheduling for counselors/psychologists across all three websites.
Humanity Library Integration	Mental health books, curated reading lists, and workshops embedded in humanitypubliclibrary.org .
Climate Anxiety Corner	Dedicated section on youthclimatenetworkbd.org addressing eco-grief and climate stress.
Peer Support Community	Moderated online support groups for different age groups, genders, and issue types.
Multilingual Content	Resources in both Bengali and English for all demographics across Bangladesh.

Climate Anxiety Scenarios & Service Pathways

Climate anxiety is not one condition — it shows up differently depending on how close someone is to the disaster and what kind of loss they are carrying. The intake form's urgency level and concern category (Section 08) route each client into one of the pathways below, so the response matches the actual scenario instead of a one-size-fits-all session.

Scenario	Presenting Need	Service Pathway	Funded By
Cyclone-displaced family (acute, first 0-3 months)	Acute stress, grief, disorientation after losing home/land	Crisis-protocol fast-track (same-day counselor contact) → free eco-grief-trained counselor → referral to YCN disaster-response programs for practical relief	Grant-funded
Coastal student whose school is disrupted by flooding/embankment failure	Academic disruption, identity loss, exam anxiety	Student Mental Health tier (BDT 500, subsidized) via Humanity Public Library booking widget → study-continuity counseling → peer group with other affected students	Subsidized
Rural mother facing repeated seasonal flooding	Chronic stress, domestic burden, isolation	Women & Families segment → free Women's Peer Circle → optional Family Therapy tier if needed	Free / Grant
Young climate activist (YCN volunteer/staff) with eco-grief or burnout	Helplessness, activism burnout, grief for the planet	Climate Anxiety Support tier (BDT 600–1,200/session) with eco-grief-trained counselor → activists' peer circle	Paid / Subsidized
Corporate/NGO staff citing climate-related work stress (B2B)	Workplace eco-anxiety, ESG/reporting pressure	Corporate Wellness B2B package → eco-anxiety-specific workshops for HR/teams	B2B revenue

06. Business Model — Hybrid Non-Profit + For-Profit Structure

Mind Shantara is deliberately structured as two legally linked entities. This is the same model used by BRAC (BRAC NGO + BRAC Enterprises) and by Wysa (nonprofit-origin research grants feeding a for-profit app). It lets the organization receive international grants (which mostly require a registered non-profit/NGO) while still generating sustainable personal and business income through the for-profit arm.

Two-Entity Structure

Entity	Legal Form (Bangladesh)	Purpose	Funding Source
Mind Shantara Foundation	Society / NGO registered with NGO Affairs Bureau (for foreign grants) + Joint Stock (local)	Free tier, peer support, climate-anxiety programs, research, advocacy	Grants, donations, CSR
Mind Shantara Ltd.	Private Limited Company registered with RJSC	Paid consultations, subscriptions, B2B corporate wellness, app/platform	Client fees, B2B contracts

How the Founder Earns Income — Legally

- Salary/stipend as Executive Director of the Foundation (paid from grant/operational budget — standard, compliant practice).
- Founder equity/dividends from Mind Shantara Ltd., which earns from paid sessions, subscriptions, and B2B contracts.
- Grant funding builds the platform and proves impact — impact data then attracts investors, corporate sponsors, and paying B2B clients, creating a self-sustaining cycle.

Governance Link Between the Two Entities

- A Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) formally links the Foundation and Ltd., so grant-funded infrastructure (website, counselor network, research) legally supports both free and paid services.
- Separate bank accounts and audited financial statements per entity — required for grant compliance and investor due diligence.
- A shared Board/Advisory Committee oversees both entities to ensure mission alignment as the business scales.

Freemium Tier Structure

Tier	Includes	Price
FREE (Foundation)	Self-help articles, mood tracker, community forum, webinars, peer support groups	Free forever
PAID (Ltd.)	1-on-1 professional sessions, certified counselors, video/audio/chat, session notes, monthly plans	BDT 500–2,000/session or BDT 2,500–6,000/month
B2B (Ltd.)	Corporate wellness, university partnerships, NGO staff support, school counseling, EAPs	BDT 15,000–1,00,000/month per institution

07. Revenue Streams

#	Revenue Stream	Model	Year 1 (BDT)	Year 3 (BDT)
1	Individual Sessions (Paid)	Per-session fee	8,00,000	35,00,000
2	Monthly Subscriptions	Freemium to Premium	5,00,000	25,00,000
3	B2B Corporate Wellness	Monthly retainer	7,00,000	40,00,000
4	University / School Packages	Semester contracts	4,00,000	20,00,000
5	Grants & Donations	NGO / INGO / UN grants	10,00,000	20,00,000
6	Workshop & Training Fees	One-time events	2,00,000	10,00,000
7	Content Partnerships	Co-created resources	1,00,000	8,00,000
	TOTAL		37,00,000	1,58,00,000

08. Client Journey — How a Client Books & Receives Service

This is the full end-to-end flow from first contact to post-session follow-up, designed for low-bandwidth Bangladeshi users and full grant/audit traceability.

Step-by-Step Booking Flow

Step	What Happens	Platform / Tool
1. Discovery	Client finds Mind Shantara via Facebook/Instagram ad, YouTube, referral, or a linked page on humanitypubliclibrary.org / youthclimatenetworkbd.org .	Social media, SEO, partner sites
2. Landing & Tier Selection	Client chooses: (a) Free self-help / peer group, or (b) Paid 1-on-1 session, or (c) B2B/institutional inquiry.	mindshantara.org homepage
3. Intake Form (Fill-Up)	Client fills a short, secure digital form: name, age, gender, phone/email, preferred language (Bangla/English), concern category (anxiety, depression, climate anxiety, relationship, academic, family, other), urgency level (routine / needs attention soon / crisis), and consent checkbox.	Web form (Google Forms MVP → custom form later)
4. Segment Auto-Tagging	Based on form answers, the system auto-tags the client into a segment (see Section 09) which routes them to the right counselor pool and pricing tier.	Backend logic / CRM tag
5. Counselor Matching	Client sees 2–3 suggested counselor profiles filtered by specialization, language, and gender preference, with ratings and short bios.	Booking page
6. Slot Selection	Client picks an available date/time from a live calendar.	Calendly / SimplyBook.me / custom scheduler
7. Payment (Paid Tier Only)	bKash, Nagad, or card payment via SSLCommerz/Stripe. Free tier and subsidized student rate skip this step or use a discount code.	bKash API + SSLCommerz
8. Confirmation	Instant confirmation via SMS, email, and WhatsApp with session link, counselor name, and a pre-session digital consent + short questionnaire.	SMS gateway, WhatsApp Business API, email
9. Pre-Session Reminder	Automated reminder 24 hours and 1 hour before the session.	Email/SMS automation
10. The Session	Video, audio, or chat session via Zoom SDK / Daily.co, chosen for Bangladesh bandwidth reliability.	Zoom SDK / Daily.co
11. Session Notes & Follow-Up	Counselor logs private clinical notes; client receives a follow-up email with resources and next-session suggestion.	CRM / EHR-style record
12. Feedback & Retention	Post-session 1–5 star rating + short survey; 3-month outcome follow-up survey for impact tracking.	Automated survey + Google Analytics

Intake Form — Exact Fields

- Full name, age, gender, phone number, email
- Location (division/district — used for the reach-mapping KPI)
- Preferred language: Bangla / English / Both
- Concern category (checklist): Anxiety, Depression, Climate/Eco-anxiety, Relationship, Academic/Career, Family, Grief, Other

- Urgency level: Routine self-care / Needs attention this week / Crisis (routes instantly to the crisis protocol — see Section 17)
- Preferred tier: Free resource / Subsidized (student) / Standard paid / B2B (organization name)
- Digital informed-consent checkbox (required before any paid session is booked)

Crisis Safety Rule: any client marking “Crisis” urgency is immediately shown the national mental health helpline number and, where possible, fast-tracked to same-day counselor contact — this flow bypasses normal queueing.

09. Market Segmentation Strategy

Segments are determined using three layers of data: (1) intake-form answers at the moment of booking, (2) behavioural data from the website/app (which pages, which resources), and (3) periodic surveys of the registered user base. This lets Mind Shantara price, market, and staff differently for each segment instead of a one-size-fits-all approach.

Segmentation Layers

Layer	Data Used	Purpose
Demographic	Age, gender, location (urban/rural), income proxy (student vs. employed vs. institution-paid)	Set pricing tier and language of content
Psychographic	Occupation type, stated concern category, climate-exposure (from youthclimatenetworkbd.org link)	Personalize content and counselor matching
Need-based	Urgency level, free-resource usage vs. session booking, repeat visits	Prioritize crisis cases, identify upsell-ready users
Ability-to-pay	Selected tier, subsidized-code usage, B2B affiliation	Route to correct pricing and revenue stream

Primary Customer Segments

Segment	Profile	Primary Offer	Revenue Role
Students (15–24)	University/college, exam & identity stress	Subsidized BDT 500/session, campus packages	Volume + grant-matched subsidy
Young Professionals (25–35)	Urban, smartphone-first, workplace stress	Premium monthly subscription	Core paid revenue
Climate-Affected Youth & Rural Communities	Linked via youthclimatenetworkbd.org, flood/cyclone-exposed	Free/subsidized climate-anxiety counseling	Grant-funded (SDG 13 angle)
Corporate Employees (B2B)	Employees of partner companies	Employer-paid wellness packages, EAPs	Highest-margin B2B revenue
Women & Families	Domestic stress, postpartum, parenting	Family therapy, women's peer circle	Mixed free + paid
General Public (Free Tier)	Broad awareness audience	Self-help articles, mood tracker, forum	Funnel → future paid conversion + grant KPI (reach)

How Segments Are Reviewed

- Monthly dashboard review of segment size, session volume, and revenue-per-segment (Google Analytics 4 + CRM export).
- Quarterly user survey to re-validate segment needs and satisfaction, feeding into the grant impact reports.
- Segment data directly powers grant reporting (e.g., % rural reach, % youth reached, % climate-affected users served).

10. Website Architecture

Three-Website Ecosystem — mindshantara.org (Main Platform)

Page	Description
Home	Hero banner with booking CTA, crisis helpline, testimonials, live statistics counter.
About Us	Mission, vision, founder story, team profiles, partnerships.
Services	Free vs. Paid tier comparison, full service catalogue.
Book a Session	Calendar-based slot booking — free consultation and paid therapy sessions.
Our Counselors	Verified professional profiles, specializations, languages spoken, ratings.
Resources	Articles, videos, self-assessment tools, mood tracker.
Climate & Mental Health	Dedicated eco-anxiety section, linking to youthclimatenetworkbd.org.
Community Forum	Peer support groups, moderated discussions, anonymous posting option.
Blog	Weekly mental health content, expert Q&A, success stories.
Contact / Crisis Line	24/7 helpline info, live chat widget, contact form.

Integration Points

- humanitypubliclibrary.org — a ‘Mind Shantara Corner’ with mental health book lists, bibliotherapy resources, self-help audio/video, and a booking widget.
- youthclimatenetworkbd.org — embedded eco-grief counseling links, mental health tips for climate activists, peer groups, and a booking widget.

Recommended Technology Stack

Component	Recommended Tool	Reason
CMS / Website	WordPress + Elementor Pro	Fast to launch, SEO-friendly, Bengali language support
Booking System	Calendly / SimplyBook.me / Custom	Free & paid tier differentiation with clear UX
Payment Gateway	bKash API + SSLCommerz + Stripe	Local and international payment coverage
Video Consultations	Zoom SDK / Daily.co	Reliable across Bangladesh bandwidths
Database / Backend	Firebase / Supabase	Real-time, scalable, cost-effective for early stage
Email Marketing	Mailchimp / SendGrid	Newsletter and automated session reminders
Analytics	Google Analytics 4 + Hotjar	User behaviour, funnel tracking, heatmaps
SEO & Content	Yoast SEO + Bengali content strategy	Rank for key Bangladesh mental health searches
Security	SSL + 2FA + data encryption	Mental health data privacy compliance (HIPAA-inspired)

11. Services in Detail

Service	Price (BDT)	Description
Individual Counseling	800–1,500/session	Licensed counselors for anxiety, depression, relationship issues, grief, trauma. Bangla and English via video, audio, or chat.
Psychiatric Consultation	1,500–3,000/session	Registered psychiatrists for medication management and diagnosis support, with referral to physical clinics for acute cases.
Family Therapy	2,000–3,500/session	Multi-person sessions for family conflict, parenting challenges, domestic issues.
Student Mental Health	500/session (subsidized)	Affordable sessions for university students — academic stress, exam anxiety, identity, career. Institution packages available.
Climate Anxiety Support	600–1,200/session	Counselors trained in eco-grief and climate anxiety, connected to youthclimatenetworkbd.org community.
Corporate Wellness	50,000–1,00,000/month	Monthly retainer: employee sessions, wellness workshops, HR training, crisis response planning.
Self-Help Resources	FREE	Articles, guided meditations, mood journal, stress tracker, psychoeducation videos.
Peer Support Groups	FREE	Moderated groups: women's circle, youth support, climate activists' circle, grief support — weekly.

12. Marketing Strategy

Brand Identity & Positioning

Element	Detail
Brand Voice	Warm, empathetic, science-based, and inclusive
Tagline (Bengali)	শান্ত হোক মন, সুন্দর হোক জীবন
Tagline (English)	Mind Shantara: Your Safe Space to Heal
Color Palette	Teal / Sky Blue (trust, calm) + Amber/Saffron (warmth, hope) + Mint Green
Logo Concept	A calm glowing star merging into a human silhouette/mind outline — with a Bangladesh-green accent
Brand Promise	Accessible, affordable, stigma-free mental health support in your language

6-Stage Marketing Funnel

Stage	Tactic	Channel	Goal
AWARENESS	Mental health content, news sharing, free webinars	Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram	Brand recognition
INTEREST	Free resources, self-assessment tools, newsletter	Website, Email	Build subscriber list
CONSIDERATION	Free consultation offer, testimonials, case studies	Website, WhatsApp	Convert curious visitors
BOOKING	Easy slot booking, bKash payment, trust signals	Website booking page	First paid session
RETENTION	Follow-up emails, progress check-ins, loyalty discounts	Email, SMS, App	Repeat sessions
ADVOCACY	Referral program, community ambassadors, reviews	Social media	Word-of-mouth growth

Organic Growth Channels

- Bengali + English SEO targeting: ‘মানসিক স্বাস্থ্য’, ‘online therapy Bangladesh’, ‘depression treatment Dhaka’
- Google Ads: targeted campaigns for urban professionals and university students (BDT 10,000/month)
- YouTube channel: mental health explainer videos in Bangla — builds authority and trust
- Podcast: ‘Moner Kotha’ — weekly conversations with psychologists and survivors
- Media outreach: editorial coverage in Prothom Alo, Daily Star, TBS News
- University partnerships: 10+ campuses for mental health awareness campaigns

13. Social Media Plan

Platform	Handle	Primary Audience	Content Focus	Frequency
Facebook	fb.com/MindShantara	General public, families, 25–45	Awareness posts, live sessions, stories	Daily
Instagram	@mindshantara	Youth, 18–30, visual learners	Infographics, quotes, reels, stories	5x/week
LinkedIn	/company/mindshantara	Professionals, HR, NGOs	Research, B2B, thought leadership	3x/week
YouTube	@MindShantaraBD	All ages, in-depth seekers	Expert talks, guided meditation, Q&A	1–2x/week
TikTok/Reels	@mindshantarabd	Gen Z, 16–25	Short mental health tips, myth-busting	Daily
WhatsApp Channel	Mind Shantara Updates	Registered users	Reminders, resources, crisis tips	3x/week

Monthly Campaign Calendar (2026–2027)

Month	Theme	Key Campaign
Aug 2026	Launch Month	#MindShantaraLaunch — Awareness blitz, free launch webinar
Sep 2026	Youth Mental Health	#MindfulYouth — Student special discount campaign
Oct 2026	Climate Anxiety	#ClimateMind — Partner campaign with youthclimatenetworkbd.org
Oct 10, 2026	World Mental Health Day	#MHDday2026 — Free consultations, media coverage, live events
Nov 2026	Workplace Wellness	#WorkplaceWell — B2B outreach, corporate wellness packages
Dec 2026	Year-End Reflection	#MindfulYear — Community highlights, first impact report

14. Competitive Analysis

Competitor	Type	Strength	Weakness	Our Advantage
Kaan Pete Roi (India)	Helpline	Trusted, free	India-only, no therapy	Full service + local BD focus
BetterHelp (Global)	Therapy platform	Large provider network	USD pricing, no Bangla	Bangla-first, local, affordable
MindSpace BD	Local startup	Bangladesh-focused	Limited counselors	Larger ecosystem, grant access
Private Psychiatrists	Offline service	Clinical credibility	Expensive, urban only	Online, affordable, scalable
iCall (India)	Online counseling	Academic backing	Limited to India	Local + climate anxiety focus
Shajgoj (BD)	Health/beauty platform	Large user base	Not mental-health focused	Dedicated, specialized platform

Our Competitive Advantages

- The only platform globally connecting climate-anxiety care with mainstream mental health services
- Rapid credibility through two established organizations with existing user bases and trust
- Hybrid non-profit + for-profit model balancing commercial sustainability and genuine social mission
- Fully bilingual — Bengali and English — built specifically for Bangladesh's context
- Freemium model makes care accessible regardless of financial ability
- Three-website ecosystem multiplies reach and creates multiple entry points for users

15. Financial Projections

3-Year Revenue & Expense Forecast (BDT)

Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Individual Sessions	8,00,000	20,00,000	35,00,000
Subscriptions	5,00,000	14,00,000	25,00,000
B2B Corporate	7,00,000	22,00,000	40,00,000
University / School	4,00,000	12,00,000	20,00,000
Grants & Donations	10,00,000	15,00,000	20,00,000
Workshops & Others	3,00,000	8,00,000	18,00,000
TOTAL REVENUE	37,00,000	91,00,000	1,58,00,000
Counselor Fees (60%)	15,00,000	38,00,000	65,00,000
Tech & Website	5,00,000	7,00,000	10,00,000
Marketing	6,00,000	14,00,000	22,00,000
Operations & Admin	4,00,000	8,00,000	12,00,000
TOTAL EXPENSES	30,00,000	67,00,000	1,09,00,000
NET SURPLUS	7,00,000	24,00,000	49,00,000

Year 1 Startup Cost Breakdown

Item	Cost (BDT)	Notes
Website Development (mindshantara.org)	2,00,000	WordPress + booking + payment integration
Branding (logo, visual identity)	50,000	Professional design agency
Marketing Launch Campaign	3,00,000	Social media, Google Ads, launch events
Counselor Onboarding & Training	1,50,000	Initial team of 5–8 licensed counselors
Legal & Registration (NGO + Ltd.)	1,20,000	Dual social-enterprise legal structure
Technology Tools (annual subscriptions)	1,20,000	Video, CRM, email, analytics tools
Reserve Fund (3 months)	2,00,000	Operational buffer for contingencies
TOTAL STARTUP COST	11,40,000	Approx. USD 9,500 at current exchange rates

16. National & International Grant + Fellowship Strategy

Mind Shantara holds a significant advantage: it is connected to two existing organizations, greatly increasing grant credibility and institutional trust. This section lays out exactly how to move from zero track record to consistently winning national and international funding, fellowships, and accelerator placements.

Phase 1 — Legal & Credibility Foundation (Month 0–2, do this before applying anywhere)

- Register Mind Shantara Foundation as a Society / NGO in Bangladesh; register separately with the NGO Affairs Bureau if receiving any foreign funds — this is mandatory for most international grants.
- Register Mind Shantara Ltd. with RJSC for the paid/B2B service arm.
- Build a simple but live website (mindshantara.org) — grant reviewers routinely check for an active web presence before funding.
- Secure at least 2–3 partnership letters or MOUs (e.g., with humanitypubliclibrary.org, youthclimatenetworkbd.org, a university, or a local clinic) — proof of execution capacity matters more than the idea alone.
- Start collecting Day-1 impact data — users served, sessions completed, satisfaction scores — even from a small pilot. Funders fund evidence, not intentions.

Phase 2 — National Funding & Support (Month 1–6)

Funder / Programme	Type	Est. Amount	Priority
Bangladesh National Mental Health Strategic Plan (DGHS)	Government alignment / support	Variable	MEDIUM
Grameenphone / Robi / bKash Foundation CSR	Corporate CSR	BDT 5–20 Lakh	HIGH
BRAC Bank / City Bank CSR	Corporate CSR	BDT 5–15 Lakh	MEDIUM
Bangladesh NGO Affairs Bureau-listed local trusts	Local grant	BDT 2–10 Lakh	MEDIUM
University research partnerships (BSMMU, DU, BUET)	In-kind + research credibility	Non-cash	HIGH

Phase 3 — International Grants (Month 4–12)

Funder	Type	Amount	Priority
WHO South-East Asia Region	UN Grant	USD 50–150K	HIGH
UNICEF Bangladesh Programme	Grant	USD 30–100K	HIGH
Global Mental Health Action Network	Advocacy Grant	USD 20–50K	HIGH
USAID Bangladesh	Development Grant	USD 50–250K	HIGH
Embassy Small Grants (US, UK, EU, Japan)	Small Grants	USD 10–30K each	HIGH
Grand Challenges Canada	Innovation Grant	CAD 100–250K	MEDIUM
Open Society Foundations	Social Impact	USD 50–200K	MEDIUM

Funder	Type	Amount	Priority
Wellcome Trust	Research Grant	GBP 50–200K	MEDIUM

Phase 4 — Fellowships & Accelerators (apply on rolling annual cycles)

Programme	What It Offers	Best Fit Reason
UNDP Youth Co:Lab	Seed funding + mentorship, Asia-Pacific youth social entrepreneurs	Direct fit — youth + social enterprise + Bangladesh
MIT Solve	Global challenge, non-dilutive grant, network access	Health equity / mental health track fits directly
Echoing Green Fellowship	USD 80–90K + 2-year leadership support	Early-stage social entrepreneur fit
Enlight Fellowship (Youth Mental Wellbeing)	16-week fully funded global fellowship	Purpose-built for youth mental-wellbeing leaders
100x Impact Accelerator (LSE)	Unrestricted grant for emerging-market ventures	Same programme that helped Wysa scale early
Ashoka Fellowship	Lifetime fellowship, global changemaker network	Strong for founder personal-brand + long-term credibility
Obama Foundation Leaders: Asia-Pacific	Leadership training + network, no direct funding	Builds founder visibility for future grant asks
Draper Richards Kaplan Foundation	USD 300K over 3 years + board support	For once traction/impact data exists (Year 2+)

How to Actually Win — Practical Application Tactics

- Use The Lancet (2026) and WHO data as the opening evidence hook in every proposal — reviewers respond to global-scale numbers backed by a specific local gap statistic (0.073 psychiatrists per 100,000).
- Lead with the founder's personal survivor story (Cyclone Aila, 2009) wherever a proposal allows a founder narrative — funders consistently rate lived-experience founders higher on authenticity and execution likelihood than founders working from secondary research alone.
- Use the climate-anxiety angle deliberately to access funding at the intersection of health and climate (SDG 3 + SDG 13) — this is a genuinely rare positioning that most mental-health applicants do not have.
- Tailor every application to the funder's stated theory of change — never submit one generic proposal to multiple funders unchanged.
- Keep a master “impact one-pager” (users served, sessions completed, % rural reach, satisfaction score) updated monthly — attach the latest version to every application.
- Submit early, never on the deadline day — many funders informally review submissions on a rolling basis even with a fixed deadline.
- Target 6–10 grant/fellowship applications per year; sector norms suggest a realistic 2–3 approvals from that pool — volume and consistency matter more than any single “perfect” application.
- Pursue media coverage early (Prothom Alo, Daily Star, TBS) — press clippings measurably strengthen grant submissions as third-party validation.
- After each rejection, request feedback where possible and reapply to the same funder's next cycle — many funders explicitly favor repeat, improving applicants.

17. Team & Operations Plan

Role	Responsibility	Timeline	Compensation
Founder & Executive Director	Strategy, partnerships, fundraising, public face	Now	Equity / Grant-funded
Clinical Director (Part-time)	Counselor vetting, clinical oversight, protocols	Month 1–2	BDT 30–50K/month
Tech Lead / Web Developer	Website build, booking system, maintenance	Month 1	BDT 40–60K/month
Marketing Manager	Social media, content, SEO, campaigns	Month 1–2	BDT 25–35K/month
3–5 Licensed Counselors	Client sessions, peer groups, content	Month 2	60% of session fee
Operations Coordinator	Scheduling, admin, bookkeeping, donor reporting	Month 2–3	BDT 20–25K/month
Volunteer / Community Manager	Forum moderation, peer groups, social listening	Month 3	Stipend / Volunteer
Grant Writer (Consultant)	Grant proposals, donor relations, reporting	As needed	Per-project fee

Clinical Governance & Safety Protocols

- All counselors must hold BPS/BCPS-registered qualifications or equivalent recognized credentials
- Informed consent policy: clients sign digital consent forms before any session begins
- Confidentiality protocol: HIPAA-inspired data protection adapted for the Bangladeshi legal context
- Crisis protocol: clear escalation pathway for suicidal ideation or acute psychiatric emergencies
- Monthly group supervision sessions for all counselors, led by the Clinical Director
- Post-session star rating (1–5) and 3-month outcome follow-up survey
- All content follows WHO/AFSP safe-messaging guidelines for mental health communication

18. Social Impact Measurement

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) Alignment

SDG	How Mind Shantara Contributes
SDG 3 — Good Health & Well-Being	Expanding mental health access for underserved populations across Bangladesh
SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities	Free and affordable services bridge the urban-rural gap in mental healthcare
SDG 13 — Climate Action	Addressing climate anxiety as a direct mental health outcome of environmental crises
SDG 4 — Quality Education	Mental health programs for students and teachers, reducing dropout from mental illness
SDG 5 — Gender Equality	Dedicated support for women facing domestic violence, postpartum depression, discrimination
SDG 17 — Partnerships for Goals	Cross-sector collaboration across health, education, environment, and civil society

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPI	Year 1 Target	Year 3 Target	Measurement Method
Registered Users	5,000	50,000	Website registration data
Paid Sessions Completed	500	10,000	Booking system records
Free Resources Accessed	20,000 downloads	2,00,000	Google Analytics
Client Satisfaction Score	>4.0 / 5.0	>4.5 / 5.0	Post-session surveys
% Clients Reporting Improvement	>60%	>75%	3-month follow-up survey
Counselors Employed	5–8	30+	HR records
Districts Reached	8 (online)	64 (all Bangladesh)	User location data
Media Mentions	20+	100+	Media monitoring tools
Grants / Fellowships Won	2–3	8–10	Grant records

19. Founder's Vision

This vision is not abstract — it grows directly out of the founder's own childhood on Bangladesh's cyclone coast. (See the full Founder & Executive Director's Statement at the opening of this document.)

"I believe every person deserves mental wellness — whether they are a wealthy urbanite in Dhaka or a farmer living on a remote char island. At humanitypubliclibrary.org, I connected people with knowledge. At youthclimatenetworkbd.org, I gave young people a voice to protect the planet. Now, with Mind Shantara, I want people to learn to protect themselves. Because a healthy mind is what builds a better world."

Founder Dimension	Details
Role	Founder & Executive Director
Lived Experience	Cyclone Aila survivor (2009) and three years of tidal flooding; grew up through Sidr, Fani, and Amphan on Bangladesh's coast — direct, first-hand experience of climate-driven psychological distress
Current Organizations	humanitypubliclibrary.org youthclimatenetworkbd.org
Areas of Expertise	Humanitarian work, Climate Advocacy, Community Building, NGO Management
Why Mind Shantara	Bridging the mental health gap using existing trust, network, and digital reach
Personal Brand Opportunity	Public intellectual bridging social service, environment, and mental health
Media Positioning	Visible face of Bangladesh's mental health movement — op-eds, TV, international conferences

20. 12-Month Roadmap (2026–2027)

Phase	Timeline	Key Actions	Milestone
Phase 1: Foundation	Aug–Sep 2026	Register Foundation + Ltd. · Launch mindshantara.org (MVP) · Onboard 5 counselors · Set up booking + payment · Launch social media · Embed widgets on 2 existing sites	Website live, 10 first bookings
Phase 2: Growth	Oct–Dec 2026	World Mental Health Day campaign · Land first B2B client · Submit 3+ grant applications · Launch peer support groups · Media outreach · Sign 1–2 university partnerships	500 registered users, BDT 5L revenue, 1 grant awarded
Phase 3: Scale	Jan–Jul 2027	Reach 2,000+ registered users · Hire full-time marketing manager · Launch annual Climate & Mental Health report · Present at an international conference · Begin mobile app planning	2,000 users, BDT 20L revenue, 2+ grants
Phase 4: Expansion	Aug 2027+	Build district-level counselor network · Launch mobile app · Regional expansion: Nepal, Myanmar · Academic research partnerships · Government mental health policy advocacy	National scale, regional presence

Mind Shantara is positioned at the intersection of three urgent global crises: the 1.2 billion people living with mental health conditions, Bangladesh's critical shortage of psychiatric services, and the growing mental health impact of climate change. With two established platforms as its foundation, a clear hybrid business model, a concrete client-booking system, a data-driven segmentation strategy, and a step-by-step national-to-international grant and fellowship plan — Mind Shantara is ready to lead Bangladesh's mental health movement.

শান্ত হোক মন, স্বন্দর হোক জীবন